



San Mateo County CA SO Transparency Portal

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individual privacy. San Mateo County CA SO utilizes retroactive search to solve crimes after they've occurred.

Additionally, San Mateo County CA SO utilizes real time alerting of hotlist vehicles to capture wanted criminals. In an effort to ensure proper usage and guardrails are in place, they have made the below policies and usage statistics available to the public.

Community Impact

Featured Success Stories

Success Story - Occupied Stolen Vehicle

On Sunday, 07/05/26, at about 5:30am, deputies received a FLOCK alert regarding a vehicle with stolen license plates in the area of Woodside Rd. and Alameda De Las Pulgas. By tracking the suspect vehicle via FLOCK, deputies were able to locate the occupied vehicle in the 100 block of Northgate Dr. in Woodside. Deputies successfully stopped the vehicle and during a thorough investigation, discovered that both the vehicle and the license plates were stolen. The occupants of the vehicle also possessed possible ID theft information, several other stolen license plates, a variety of power tools, and suspected methamphetamine. The stolen vehicle was ultimately released to the registered owner. Both suspects were arrested and booked into the San Mateo County Jail for violations of numerous criminal statutes. FLOCK was integral to the identification and location of the suspect vehicle. This case highlights how proactive enforcement and the use of FLOCK can solve crimes and prevent future ones.

Success Story - Felony Hit & Run

On 07/01/26, at approximately 6:45 p.m., deputies responded to Woodside Rd. and Hacienda Dr. in Woodside following a reported hit-and-run collision. Upon arrival, deputies learned the victim was riding a horse along the shoulder of the road, which is commonly used by bicyclists and equestrians, when a vehicle struck the horse from behind and fled the scene. Both the horse and rider sustained injuries but survived. Through witness statements and investigative tools, including FLOCK, deputies identified the involved vehicle and registered owners. Deputies are continuing to conduct follow-up investigative work, including collecting and reviewing all available evidence. The use of FLOCK greatly reduced the time it took for deputies to identify the suspect vehicle.

Success Story - Residential Burglary

On 06/15/2026, deputies investigated a report of a 2-day old residential burglary in the Town of Woodside. Home security footage showed two suspects entering the garage on the property and rummaging through items. When the home's alarm system activated, the suspects fled. Deputies reviewed the footage, which showed the vehicle the suspects were

driving. Using FLOCK, deputies identified the vehicle and focused their investigation. On 06/16/26, deputies located the vehicle in Redwood City. Two suspects were arrested for PC 460(A): Residential Burglary. Though this case was reported 2-days after the crime occurred, FLOCK allowed deputies to quickly identify and arrest the suspects.

Success Story - Road Rage / Firearm / Narcotics

On 06/14/2026, around 8:30 p.m., deputies were dispatched to a location in Montara following reports of a road rage incident. During the incident, the suspect reportedly pointed a firearm at the victim, was speeding, and driving erratically. The suspect fled the area, but witnesses were able to provide a description of the suspect and the vehicle he was driving. Using FLOCK, deputies identified the vehicle and were able to focus their search efforts. A short time later, deputies located the suspect nearby. During the investigation, deputies located a semi-automatic firearm, ammunition, narcotics, illegal fireworks, and a false registration tab in the suspect’s possession. The suspect, who was already prohibited from possessing firearms, was arrested on several charges including: PC 245(A)(2): Assault with a firearm, PC 29800(a)(1): Felon in possession of a firearm, and HS 11351: Possession of a controlled substance for sale. The use of FLOCK in this case greatly shortened the time it took for deputies to locate and safely arrest a dangerous felon.

Success Story - Stolen Vehicle

On 06/06/2026, Sheriff's Deputies in unincorporated Redwood City were alerted to a stolen vehicle in the area, via a FLOCK notification. Deputies responded to the area and quickly located the occupied vehicle. Deputies initiated a traffic stop but the driver failed to yield, which led to a short vehicle pursuit. At the conclusion of the pursuit, deputies safely and successfully took the juvenile driver into custody. The driver was also in possession of burglary tools. He was arrested for possession of a stolen vehicle, evading a peace officer with wanton disregard for public safety, and possession of burglary tools. This case highlights the effectiveness of using FLOCK's automated license plate reader (ALPR) technology in supporting public safety and preventing future crimes.

Success Story - Best Buy Serial Computer/Laptop Thief

On 02/23/2024 and 03/23/2024, a suspect entered the Best Buy in San Carlos and stole multiple computers and laptops valued at approximately \$3,000. A suspect vehicle was observed fleeing the scene, and FLOCK enabled deputies to obtain a license plate for the vehicle. Detectives identified a family member of the registered vehicle owner who matched the suspect's description. It was discovered that this suspect had committed similar thefts at Best Buy stores throughout the Bay Area. Detectives and deputies learned of a new suspect vehicle being used by the perpetrator, and FLOCK assisted in identifying this vehicle. In April 2024, deputies and detectives monitored the suspect and the vehicle in question. The suspect returned to the Best Buy in San Carlos on 04/27/2024, where he was arrested for the previous thefts.

Success Story - Arson via Molotov Cocktail

On 05/16/2024, around 3:00am, a suspect threw a Molotov cocktail at a residence in San Carlos. The fire spread rapidly, resulting in the destruction of two vehicles, part of a residential garage, some exterior property, and a section of a tree. Fortunately, the residents managed to escape the area unharmed. Using surveillance video and FLOCK, investigators identified a suspect vehicle that left the area shortly after the incident. With this information, they were able to develop additional leads on the suspect. Search warrants were issued and investigators obtained additional surveillance footage and FLOCK images, which clearly linked the suspect to the arson. This information resulted in the arrest of a suspect, who was prosecuted for arson of an inhabited structure by the San Mateo County District Attorney.

Success Story - Residential Burglary/Package Thefts from Apartments

On 08/06/2024 and 08/07/2024, during the early morning hours, two suspects entered different apartment buildings in San Carlos without access or authorization. These suspects entered the mailrooms and stole multiple packages from both buildings. Using surveillance video, detectives obtained descriptions of the suspects and their vehicle. Through FLOCK, a suspect vehicle was located. Detectives and deputies identified one of the involved suspects, who was on post-release community supervision out of Alameda County. They arranged for the probation officer to bring the suspect into the Hayward Probation Office. Detectives contacted the suspect at the office and found additional evidence related to these cases. This case is under review by the San Mateo County District Attorney for prosecution.

Data & Usage Summary

Data Retention

The number of days data is retained.

30 days

Total Cameras

Number of LPR and other cameras.

109

Vehicles detected in the last 30 days

Number of unique plate reads over the last 30 days.

1,244,135

Number of Searches

Total user search sessions over the last 30 days.

1,151

Hotlists Alerted On

National and statewide hotlist sources.

California SVS, NCMEC Amber Alert

Number of Hotlist Hits

Total hotlist hits over the last 30 days.

9,950

Sharing Network Data With

Organizations granted access to San Mateo County CA SO data.

Alameda CA PD

Albany CA PD

Anaheim CA PD

Angels Camp CA PD

Arcadia CA PD

Barstow CA PD

Beaumont CA PD

Belvedere CA PD

Berkeley CA PD

Brisbane CA PD

Cal Fire

California Department of Fish & Wildlife (CA)

California State Parks

Campbell CA PD

Carmel CA PD

Central Marin CA PD

Citrus Heights CA PD

Alameda County CA SO

Alhambra CA PD

Anderson CA PD

Antioch CA PD

Atherton CA PD

Bear Valley Springs CA PD

Belmont CA PD

Benicia CA PD

Brentwood CA PD

Burlingame CA PD

California Department of Corrections

California Highway Patrol

Calistoga CA PD

Capitola CA PD

Cathedral City CA PD

Cerritos College CA PD

City of Lemoore CA

City of Monte Sereno CA

Clayton CA PD

Cloverdale CA PD

Colusa CA PD

Contra Costa County CA SO

Cotati CA PD

Daly City CA PD

Desert Hot Springs CA PD

Dublin CA PD (ACSO)

East Palo Alto CA PD

El Segundo CA PD

Emeryville CA PD

Fairfield CA PD

Fort Bragg CA PD

Fountain Valley CA PD

Fremont CA PD

Fullerton CA PD

Garden Grove CA PD

Glendora (CA) PD

Greenfield CA PD

Gustine PD CA

Hayward CA PD

Hercules CA PD

Hillsborough CA PD

Humboldt County CA SO

Imperial County CA SO

Irvine CA PD

Kensington CA PD

Kern County CA SO

Kings County Sheriff's Office CA

La Mesa CA PD

Laguna Beach CA PD

Claremont CA PD

Clearlake CA PD

Colma CA PD

Concord CA PD

Corona CA PD

Cypress CA PD

Danville CA PD

Dixon CA PD

East Bay Parks CA PD

El Dorado County CA SO

Elk Grove CA PD

Escalon CA PD

Folsom CA PD

Foster City CA PD

Fowler CA PD

Fresno CA PD

Galt CA PD

Gilroy CA PD

Grass Valley CA PD

Grover Beach CA PD

Hanford CA PD

Hemet CA PD

Hermosa Beach PD CA

Hollister CA PD

Imperial City CA PD

Indio CA PD

Irwindale CA PD

Kerman CA PD

Kings County CA DAs Office

La Habra CA PD

La Verne CA PD

Lake County CA SO

Lakeport CA PD
LASD CA - San Dimas Station
Lincoln CA PD
Livingston CA PD
Lompoc CA PD
Los Altos CA PD
Los Angeles County CA SD
Los Gatos CA
Madera County SO CA
Marin County CA DA
Marina CA PD
Mendocino County SO-CA
Menifee CA PD
Merced County CA SO
Milpitas CA PD
Montclair CA PD
Monterey County CA SO
Monterey Park CA PD
Morgan Hill CA PD
Napa CA PD
National City CA PD
Nevada City CA PD
Newark CA PD
Novato CA PD
Oakley CA PD
Ontario CA PD
Orange County (CA) DA Office
Orange County SO CA
Pacific Grove CA PD
Palm Springs CA PD
Pasadena CA PD
Piedmont CA PD
Placer County CA DA Office

Lancaster CA PD
Lathrop CA PD
Livermore CA PD
Lodi CA PD
Los Alamitos PD CA
Los Angeles CA PD
Los Angeles Port Police CA
Madera CA PD
Manteca CA PD
Marin County CA SO
McFarland CA PD
Mendota CA PD
Menlo Park CA PD
Mill Valley CA PD
Modoc County CA SO
Monterey CA PD
Monterey County District Attorney's Office
Moraga CA PD
Murrieta CA PD
Napa County CA SO
NCRIC
Nevada County CA SO
Newport Beach PD CA
Oakland CA PD
Oceanside CA PD
Orange CA PD
Orange County Fire Authority (CA)
Oroville CA PD
Pacifica CA PD
Palo Alto CA PD
Petaluma CA PD
Placentia CA PD
Placer County CA SO

Pleasant Hill CA PD

Pomona CA PD

Porterville CA PD

Redlands CA PD

Redwood City CA PD

Rialto PD CA

Ridgecrest CA PD

Rio Vista CA PD

Riverside County CA District Attorney

Rocklin CA PD

Roseville CA PD

Sacramento County CA SO

San Benito County SO CA

San Bernardino Community College CA PD

San Bruno CA PD

San Diego County CA SO

San Fernando CA PD

San Francisco District Attorney CA

San Joaquin CA DA

San Jose CA PD

San Luis Obispo CA PD

San Mateo CA PD

San Pasqual CA PD

San Ramon CA PD

Sanger CA PD

Santa Barbara County CA SO

Santa Clara CA PD

Santa Clara DA CA

Santa Monica CA PD

Sausalito CA PD

Seaside CA PD

Shasta County SO

Pleasanton CA PD

Port of Stockton CA PD

Redding PD - CA

Redondo Beach CA PD

Reedley CA PD

Richmond CA PD

Rio Hondo College PD CA

RIV CO ARSON TF CA PD

Riverside County CA SO

Rohnert Park Department of Public Safety (CA)

Sacramento CA DA

Salinas CA PD

San Bernardino CA PD

San Bernardino County CA SO

San Diego CA PD

San Diego Harbor CA PD

San Francisco CA PD

San Gabriel CA PD

San Joaquin County CA SO

San Leandro CA PD

San Luis Obispo County (CA) Sheriff

San Pablo CA PD

San Rafael CA PD

Sand City CA PD

Santa Ana CA PD

Santa Barbara PD CA

Santa Clara County CA SO

Santa Maria CA PD

Santa Rosa CA PD

Seal Beach CA PD

Selma CA PD

Simi Valley CA PD

Solano County CA SO

Solano County DA CA

Soledad CA PD

Sonoma County CA SO

South Gate CA PD

South Pasadena CA PD

South San Francisco CA PD

St. Helena CA PD

Stallion Springs CA PD

Stockton CA PD

Suisun City CA PD

Sunnyvale CA PD

What's Detected

License Plates, Vehicles

What's Not Detected

Facial recognition, People, Gender, Race

Tiburon CA PD

Acceptable Use Policy

Tracy CA PD

Data is used for law enforcement purposes only.

Data is owned by San Mateo County CA SO and is never sold to 3rd parties.

Tulare County CA SO

Town of Woodside CA (SMCSO)

Prohibited Uses

Trinity County SO CA

Immigration enforcement, traffic enforcement,

harassment or intimidation, usage based solely on a protected class (i.e. race, sex, religion), Personal

Tulare CA PD

Tustin CA PD

Access Poilicy

Union City CA PD

All system access requires a valid reason and is stored indefinitely.

Vacaville CA PD

Ukiah CA PD

Upland CA PD

Vallejo CA PD

Ventura CA PD

Hotlist Policy

Hotlist Policy requires that by a human verified prior to action

Ventura County CA SO

Vernon CA PD

Visalia CA PD

Walnut Creek CA PD

Watsonville CA PD

West Covina CA PD

West Sacramento CA PD

Westminster CA PD

Wheatland CA PD

Whittier CA PD

Williams CA PD

Willits CA PD

Winters CA PD

Woodlake CA PD

Woodland CA PD

San Mateo Sheriff's Office ALPR Policy

Yreka CA PD

https://www.smcsheriff.com/sites/default/files/content_files/Automated_License_Plate_Readers_ALPRs_0.pdf

Yolo County CA SO

Yuba City CA PD

Yuba County Sheriffs Office

Policy & Trust

More Info